



NINE TO fivers

Women, careers and marriage do not mix. If that raises your hackles, check out the new report—'Preventive Healthcare and Corporate Female Workforce'—brought out by the Associated Chamber of Commerce and Industry that is likely to give urban India's 27 per cent nine-to-five women more sleepless nights: 68 per cent between age 21-52 have lifestyle disorders; long hours and tight deadlines push 75 per cent into depression and general anxiety disorder, compared to women with less hectic lives; work pressure leads 53 per cent to skip meals and gorge on junk food; 77 per cent avoid routine check-ups, although 22 per cent end up spending between Rs 500 and Rs 5,000 on lifestyle disorders, from obesity to spondylosis. Are women out there listening?

70%

INDIANS WITH HIGH BP
DON'T SEEK HELP. 50%
STOP TREATMENT
WITHIN A YEAR OF
GETTING DIAGNOSED.

What you eat shapes how you sleep

SMOKESCREEN

Don't be fooled by a 'relaxing' smoke. Nicotine is a stimulant. Avoid smoking before bedtime or if you wake up in the middle of the night.



THE MILKY WAY

A warm glass of milk before bed? Yes. Science supports those ancient words. That's because dairy foods contain tryptophan, a sleep-inducing amino acid. Other such foods are poultry, bananas, oats and honey.



BOOZE SNOOZE

Here's the catch with alcohol: It may help you fall asleep faster, but you're likely to have headaches, night-sweats and restlessness. Balance each glass of drink in the evening with a glass of water to dilute and thus minimise the effect.



CARB CATCH

Carbs raise tryptophan levels and induce sleep. But don't pig out on fried food. The more fat you consume, the less likely you'll have a restful night.



CUP OF WOE

An evening cup of coffee might disrupt your sleep. But don't forget the less obvious caffeine sources: chocolate, colas and tea.



SORRY ATKINS

Go low on protein. Remember, protein is harder to digest and the amino acid tyrosine promotes brain activity.



POP STORY

Pain relievers, weight-loss pills, diuretics, and cold medicines often have a lot of caffeine. Check drug labels.



Putting a new spin on fitness routines



REUBEN SINGH

Break out of your regular workout routine and try spinning. This fairly new, high-energy cycling on stationary bikes has become popular in gyms and helps you burn 500 to 800 calories in one hour. Usually done in a group to loud music, spinning targets specific muscles in your body—the quadriceps, hamstrings, hips, calves and even the abs. Fitness experts clarify that spinning is not just cycling, it is an exercise, just as there is a difference between walking to the market and power walking.